OSINT

The Discipline of Seeing What Is Already Public

THE HOOK

"WHAT CAN A STRANGER LEARN ABOUT YOU IN 10 MINUTES — WITHOUT BREAKING A SINGLE LAW?"

Why is a police officer teaching you OSINT

Why me?

- 23 years in criminal investigation
- Evidence handling, source verification, chain of reasoning
- Now: master's student, new to cyber — like you

WHAT OSINT IS (AND IS NOT)

OSINT = Open Source Intelligence

- Intelligence collected from **publicly available sources**
- **Not** hacking. **Not** scanning. **Not** breaking in.
- It is the **reconnaissance phase** — the first step before any technical test

The scale of the open field

The open field is enormous

- 181 zettabytes of data created in 2025 (up from 64.2 in 2020)
- 484,142 publicly listable cloud storage buckets holding 18.05 billion files (Oct 2026)
- OSINT market: $8.7B–$22.95B in 2026 (six estimates)
- Europol Trackathon 2026: 57 fugitive cases, new leads in 56

THE METHOD

COLLECTION → VERIFICATION → ANALYSIS → REPORTING

SAME AS A POLICE INVESTIGATION

Legal and ethical boundaries

Public does not mean "fair game"

- Finnish Criminal Code Ch. 38: unlawful access up to 2 years; gross breach up to 3 years
- GDPR applies to personal data — even if public
- Terms of service are not law, but have consequences
- **Rule for today's lab:** only investigate yourself

TOOL OVERVIEW

A small toolkit — not a tutorial

- Google dorks — site:, filetype:, intitle:
- theHarvester — emails, subdomains, hosts
- Shodan — index of exposed devices and services
- Wayback Machine — archived versions of websites
- WHOIS / DNS — domain ownership and infrastructure

THE LAB: "FIND YOURSELF"

LAB: FIND YOURSELF (10 MINUTES)
ANSWER FIVE QUESTIONS USING ONLY PUBLIC SOURCES:

- WHAT DOES A SEARCH ENGINE RETURN FOR YOUR FULL NAME + CITY?
- WHAT USERNAMES LINK TO YOU ACROSS PLATFORMS?
- WHAT DOES WHOIS/DNS SHOW ABOUT A DOMAIN YOU OWN OR A CLUB YOU BELONG TO?
- WHAT DOES THE WAYBACK MACHINE SHOW ABOUT A SITE YOU USED YEARS AGO?
- (OPTIONAL) WHAT DOES SHODAN SHOW ABOUT A DEVICE ON YOUR HOME NETWORK?

RULES: PUBLIC SOURCES ONLY · NO LOGIN ATTEMPTS · NO SCANNING · ONLY YOURSELF

Lab Debrief

Debrief

- What surprised you?
- What was easy to find?
- What would you want removed — and how?
- What does this tell you about your own exposure?

THE DEFENSIVE ANGLE

From finding to defending

- Reduce your own footprint: privacy settings, data removal, alias discipline
- For organizations: OSINT is part of **threat intelligence** and **attack surface management**
- The attacker sees what you leave open. The defender should see it first.

Why this matters for your studies

Why a master's student should care

- First lab that produces a visible result without a steep technical barrier
- Builds **investigative discipline** — verification, corroboration, reporting
- Gateway to **threat intelligence**, **penetration testing**, **digital forensics**
- Legal, ethical, immediately useful

TAKEAWAYS

THREE THINGS TO TAKE HOME

- OSINT IS **INVESTIGATION, NOT HACKING** — PUBLIC SOURCES, LAWFUL METHOD
- THE METHOD IS **COLLECTION → VERIFICATION → ANALYSIS → REPORTING**
- **VISIBILITY IS THE FIRST STEP TO DEFENCE**

SOURCES AND QUESTIONS

SOURCES

- COURSE TASK PAGE: *H2 SCENE # ↑*
- OSINT MARKET AND DATA VOLUME: AXIS INTELLIGENCE, *OSINT STATISTICS 2026*; DATAREPORTAL 2025
- FINNISH CRIMINAL CODE CH. 38, SECTIONS 8, 8A, 9 — VIA ICLG, *CYBERSECURITY LAWS AND REGULATIONS 2026: FINLAND*
- EUROPOL, *EUROPE-WIDE RACE TO LOCATE FUGITIVES UNFOLDS AT EUROPOL* (TRACKATHON 2026)
- TOOL DOCUMENTATION: SHODAN, THEHARVESTER, WAYBACK MACHINE
- AI DISCLOSURE: USED AN AI ASSISTANT TO LOCATE STATISTICS AND CROSS-CHECK LEGAL REFERENCES. ALL FACTS VERIFIED AGAINST CITED SOURCES.

QUESTIONS?